

a manufacturer of silicon microphones that improve voice-input quality in consumer devices. The company needed visibility and control over inventory and processes that spanned in-house and third-party factories and warehouses in the US, Europe and Asia. It uses NetSuite to manage its supply chain and financial operations. Real-time data integration has improved performance of and visibility into a geographically-diverse supply chain. Akustica has achieved greater accuracy, ensuring auditability with Net-

Suite. Analysing real-time data from across the supply chain has enabled the company to continuously improve processes and position itself for growth.

Toyota Handling Materials, France, has a factory in Italy and wanted proper acknowledgement and delivery of orders. It aimed at organising the production or purchase of the right trucks from the right business units abroad and, subsequently, organise shipment and invoice for customers. It started using Odoo Sales, Odoo Inventory, Odoo Manufacturing and

Odoo Purchase. These are multiple apps under the umbrella of Odoo ERP tool. The main benefit of Odoo is short implementation time, and even for a complex project, the company was ready within a few months.

There are various other tools available based on different business requirements, company size, etc and many offer a free trial. These tools can make a profound difference in the way business operations are carried out in an organisation.

—Deeksha Sharma

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SECURITY:

“For Any Business, Having An INTERNAL TEAM For The IoT SECURITY Is COMPULSORY”

➤ Both solution providers and customers of the Internet of Things (IoT) are in a phase of constant evaluation of strategies to overcome the challenges that exist in the ecosystem. Karen Ravindranath, director - IoT, WebNMS, shares her thoughts with Paromik Chakraborty about the current hardware capacity, security and implementation ecosystem around the IoT in India

Q. What are the major challenges in the IoT ecosystem at present?

A. Standardisation is a big issue. Because of that, transitioning from one vendor to another will obviously be a challenge in terms of investment. To avoid this, WebNMS has a heterogeneous system and therefore does not stay tied to a particular vendor.

In addition, in India, capex is a challenge since the IoT involves huge investments into hardware. We see our partners coming up with different business models such as pay-as-you-go. I believe, once this matures it will be much better.

Q. How is the shortfall of a proper hardware ecosystem affecting the IoT adoption rate?

A. For India to take the IoT forward in a liable and cost-effective manner, the hardware ecosystem needs to develop well in India as well. So, there



Karen Ravindranath, director - IoT, WebNMS

is a huge need for a strong hardware ecosystem here. Some startups are doing their bit and coming up with new products, but a lot more still needs to be done to strengthen the ecosystem.

In terms of hardware, Europe has a very sophisticated setup. Some of our components come from China as

well. But India can really push herself to that place.

Q. There are suggestions for creating low-cost fab facilities in India to address this challenge. Do you see that happening anytime soon?

A. There is some push from the government in this aspect with Make in India initiative, but expectations have to be turned into reality. There has to be a clear path forward or some incentivisation for focusing on bringing fabrication facilities in India. That needs to be done by the government along with bringing in more investments in the country.

Q. There are many technical jargons going around for the IoT security. How strong is security in reality?

A. In this aspect, some focus has come in terms of standard products. We know there is an encryption